

Lesson 7: Build Your 90-Day Opportunity Plan

What You're Doing Today

You've spent six lessons building real things: a professional presence, content pieces, a presence on more channels, and your first networking contacts. Today you turn all of that into one plan — a 90-day calendar with three monthly blocks that tells you exactly what to do and when, so it actually happens instead of staying scattered.

Why This Matters

Here's the truth about most plans people never follow: they're either too big ("I'm going to post every day and message 20 people this week") or too vague ("I'll keep working on my stuff"). Both fail. The first burns you out in a week. The second never turns into anything you can point to.

A good plan is **paced and specific**. Small, consistent actions beat sporadic bursts almost every time. One piece of content every 2–3 weeks for three months gives you 5 finished pieces. One weekend where you try to make 5 pieces at once usually gives you 2 finished pieces and then nothing for two months, because you burned out.

And a plan doesn't mean nothing can change. It's a **default**, not a cage. If something better comes along in Month 2, you can take it. The plan just means you're not starting from zero every week trying to figure out what to do next.

Breaking 90 Days Into 3 Monthly Blocks

Your plan has three sections, each covering about 30 days:

- **Month 1 (Days 1–30):** Get moving on what's already in progress. Finish something you started. Make your first networking touchpoint of the plan.
- **Month 2 (Days 31–60):** Build momentum. Publish new content. Reach out to new contacts. Take action on a concrete opportunity (apply, submit, register).
- **Month 3 (Days 61–90):** Finish strong. Wrap up your content total. Follow up with contacts. Complete or submit your opportunity goal.

Each block needs three kinds of goals:

1. **Content goals** — what you'll finish or publish, roughly one piece every 2–3 weeks (aim for 5 total across 90 days).
2. **Networking goals** — at least one touchpoint per month (a message, reply, or introduction — not necessarily a big ask).

3. **Opportunity goal(s)** — one or two specific, checkable things you're working toward (a competition entry, an application, a submission).

Every goal also needs a **"how I'll know"** — a real piece of evidence that proves you did it: a published link, a sent message you can point to, a confirmation email.

Worked Example: Jordan's Plan

Jordan is a junior who wants to break into game development. Going into this lesson, Jordan has: a portfolio site, one finished blog post and one half-finished project writeup, a presence on a game-dev forum and a Discord server, and one cold email sent to an indie developer with no reply yet.

Month 1: Finish the half-finished writeup and publish it (Week 2). Start drafting a new short piece (done by Week 4). Follow up with the indie developer if no reply by Day 10. Introduce self in the Discord server. Find one game jam or student competition with a deadline in the next 90 days.

Month 2: Publish the piece drafted in Month 1. Start a third piece. Message 2 new contacts (a teacher, a meetup organizer, someone active in the Discord) — spaced out, not both the same day. Submit an entry to the competition found in Month 1, or get halfway through the jam project.

Month 3: Finish and publish piece 3 (and piece 4 or 5 if the pace allows — 5 pieces total is the target). Follow up with the 2 contacts from Month 2, and send one more new message. Finish and submit the competition entry if not already done. Write a short reflection on what came of the outreach.

Notice: nothing here is vague. Every action has a rough date and something checkable.

Key Terms

- **Cadence** — how often you produce or publish something on a repeating schedule (e.g., "one piece every 2–3 weeks").
- **Milestone** — a specific, dated checkpoint inside your plan that marks real progress (e.g., "piece #3 published by Day 70").
- **Opportunity goal** — a concrete, checkable target tied to a real chance to grow (an application, a competition, a submission, a specific ask) — not a vague hope like "get better" or "get noticed."

Step-by-Step Activity

1. Open your Worksheet (Google Doc or your planning tool).
2. List what you already have from Lessons 1–6: your presence, your content pieces (finished and in progress), your channels, and your networking contacts so far.
3. Fill in Month 1: what will you finish or start, who will you reach out to, what opportunity will you identify.
4. Fill in Month 2: what new content publishes, who are your new contacts, what action do you take on your opportunity goal.

5. Fill in Month 3: how do you finish your content total (aim for 5 pieces across 90 days), follow up with contacts, and complete your opportunity goal.
6. For every goal, write down how you'll know you did it — a link, a log, a confirmation.
7. Read your whole plan back. If any month has more than 2–3 actions, move something to a later month.

Knowledge Checks

1. Roughly how often should you aim to publish a content piece over the 90 days? What's the total target?
2. Why does a plan that's "too much at once" usually fail, even for a motivated person?
3. Give an example of a networking touchpoint that is NOT a big, formal ask.
4. What's the difference between a content goal and an opportunity goal? Give one example of each.
5. Why does every goal in your plan need a "how I'll know" statement?

Reflection Prompts

1. Which month of your plan feels the most realistic for your actual schedule, and which one worries you? Why?
2. Is there an opportunity (competition, program, application) you already know about that you could put into your plan right now?
3. If something unplanned but exciting came up in Month 2, how would you decide whether to adjust your plan around it?

Submission Instructions

Submit your completed Worksheet (Google Doc or your planning tool export) with all three monthly blocks filled in: content goals, networking goals, opportunity goal(s), and a "how I'll know" statement for each. Make sure at least one opportunity goal names something specific and real, not a general hope.